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SZ: What is the impact on the overall aviation ecosystem on account of this kind of policy framework of the Narendra Modi government?

SK: The big difference that I see over the past 8-9 years in particular has been the confidence that consistent policy has created in the minds of entrepreneurs. When you look at the various reforms, the formalisation of the economy... these steps have created a lot of confidence in entrepreneurs within India, capital providers from India and overseas. The fact that they are coming together is creating this perfect situation that both can coexist, both can be certain of the other... To me that is the most encouraging part.

VD: To give you a sense of the change, Akasa launched its first international flight in March 2024... Never in the history of Indian aviation has an airline launched an international sector within 18 months [of starting operations]... There was very specific pol-

“What’s so exciting about aviation is that you’ve got this amazing growth ahead of you. I don’t look at aviation in India on the back of one week or one day. I look at it on the back of years”

icy change that enabled that. Today, we fly to Doha, Kuwait, Jeddah, Riyadh and Abu Dhabi. And we’re thinking of many other international destinations in Southeast Asia and Africa. There’s policy change that has allowed this kind of growth.